

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Hospitality and Tourism English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 Arrival before check-in

02 A noise complaint

03 Overbooking plan

04 Rate strategy

05 Room out of order

06 Banquet run of show

07 Tour disruption

08 Service preferences

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Arrival before check-in

Front desk and housekeeping coordinate an early arrival.

Roles: Front-desk agent / Housekeeping supervisor

Front-desk agent: Our group arrived an hour early. Do we have any inspected rooms ready?

Housekeeping supervisor: Six are clean, but only four have passed inspection. I'll confirm those room numbers.

Front-desk agent: I'll offer luggage storage and explain that the remaining rooms are still being prepared.

Housekeeping supervisor: Please don't issue keys for the two uninspected rooms yet.

Front-desk agent: Understood. Can you give me a time for the next room-status update?

Housekeeping supervisor: I'll update the property-management system after inspection and call you if any room is delayed.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Our group arrived an hour early. Do we have any inspected rooms ready?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

A noise complaint

Guest relations follows up on an overnight complaint.

Roles: Guest-relations agent / Duty manager

Guest-relations agent: A guest says corridor noise kept them awake, and their first call wasn't followed up.

Duty manager: Acknowledge both the disturbance and the missed response. Have we checked the incident log?

Guest-relations agent: Yes. The call was logged, but no follow-up action was recorded.

Duty manager: I'll investigate that gap. What remedy falls within your current service-recovery authority?

Guest-relations agent: I can offer the approved options, subject to availability, and ask which would help.

Duty manager: Good. Record the agreed response and check back with the guest afterward.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Acknowledge both the disturbance and the missed response. Have we checked the incident log?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Overbooking plan

Reservations and the duty manager review an overbooked night.

Roles: Reservations supervisor / Duty manager

Reservations supervisor: We have two more confirmed bookings than available rooms after the maintenance closure.

Duty manager: Verify the inventory and follow our relocation policy before contacting any guest.

Reservations supervisor: A nearby partner hotel has rooms, but I haven't confirmed transport or the rate arrangement.

Duty manager: Confirm the complete arrangement and any accessibility requirements first.

Reservations supervisor: I'll prepare accurate options and identify who will speak with the affected guests.

Duty manager: I'll approve the response within our policy and make sure the handoff reaches the receiving hotel.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "We have two more confirmed bookings than available rooms after the maintenance closure." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Rate strategy

A hotel reviews rates for a busy weekend.

Roles: Revenue manager / Sales manager

Revenue manager: Pickup is strong, but the group inquiry would use our remaining large rooms at a lower rate.

Sales manager: The group also brings meeting-space and banquet revenue. Have you included that contribution?

Revenue manager: Not yet. I'll compare total revenue and displacement on the same dates.

Sales manager: Include the tentative rooming list and the cancellation terms.

Revenue manager: Then we can assess the offer against forecast demand rather than occupancy alone.

Sales manager: I'll keep the proposal provisional until we've agreed on the complete commercial terms.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The group also brings meeting-space and banquet revenue. Have you included that contribution?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Room out of order

Housekeeping reports a maintenance issue.

Roles: Housekeeping supervisor / Maintenance coordinator

Housekeeping supervisor: Room 214 has a leaking fixture. I've marked it out of order and notified the desk.

Maintenance coordinator: Is the affected area contained under our procedure, and do we have access?

Housekeeping supervisor: The room is vacant. I'll send the work order and observed condition.

Maintenance coordinator: I'll assess the repair before estimating when it can return to inventory.

Housekeeping supervisor: Let me know when cleaning and inspection can follow.

Maintenance coordinator: I'll update the work order; maintenance completion alone won't mark the room guest-ready.

Notice the professional language

out of order - A room or item unavailable for normal use because of a problem or required work.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Banquet run of show

An event team coordinates a late agenda change.

Roles: Banquet captain / Event coordinator

Banquet captain: The keynote has moved fifteen minutes later. Does dinner service move with it?

Event coordinator: The client wants starters served before the speech and mains afterward.

Banquet captain: I'll check kitchen timing. We also need a clear cue for clearing plates.

Event coordinator: I'll add the revised cues to the run of show and brief audiovisual staff.

Banquet captain: Please confirm the final guest count and dietary information through the agreed list.

Event coordinator: I'll issue one revised version so every team follows the same schedule.

Notice the professional language

run of show - A timed sequence of an event's activities and responsibilities.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Tour disruption

A tour operator responds to a closed attraction.

Roles: Tour guide / Operations coordinator

Tour guide: The museum has closed unexpectedly. The group is due there at two.

Operations coordinator: We need to verify an alternative that fits the group's access needs and available time.

Tour guide: The riverside option would involve more walking. I shouldn't assume that suits everyone.

Operations coordinator: Correct. I'll check transport and availability for the indoor alternative.

Tour guide: I'll explain the confirmed closure and tell the group when to expect the revised plan.

Operations coordinator: I'll confirm arrangements before you present them as booked.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The museum has closed unexpectedly. The group is due there at two." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Service preferences

Two staff members plan service for an international business group.

Roles: Guest-relations manager / Restaurant supervisor

Guest-relations manager: The organizer asked for a quieter seating area and a shorter lunch service.

Restaurant supervisor: Let's confirm the actual preferences rather than infer them from where the group comes from.

Guest-relations manager: I'll ask about timing, dietary needs, and whether they want individual or shared ordering.

Restaurant supervisor: I can offer two service formats with clear timings.

Guest-relations manager: We'll send those options and record the organizer's choice.

Restaurant supervisor: I'll brief the team on the confirmed arrangements without making assumptions about individual guests.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The organizer asked for a quieter seating area and a shorter lunch service." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

SHARED CASE

A guest arrives before the room is ready after receiving an unclear confirmation message. The desk has a luggage-storage option but no verified room-ready time.

Role A | Responding professional

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Useful expressions

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Cover this until after your first attempt

I'm sorry the message was unclear. Your room is not ready yet. We can store your luggage while I check the status, and I'll give you an update as soon as I have a confirmed time.

Second round

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

SHARED CASE

A draft response to an online review argues with the guest and includes booking details. The team needs a courteous public reply.

Role A | Responding professional

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can explain a practical obstacle affecting the work. Share it after your partner asks for your perspective, then agree on one observable change.

Useful expressions

In [specific situation], I noticed

The effect was What was happening from your perspective?

Could we agree to ... and review it ...?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Thank you for sharing your experience. We're sorry the visit did not meet expectations. Please contact our service team through the private channel so we can review the details with you.

Second round

The recipient disagrees with your interpretation. Return to the observed example, listen, and revise an unsupported assumption.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

SHARED CASE

A booking issue means the reserved room type is unavailable. Staff have two alternatives within their approved service process.

Role A | Responding professional

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Useful expressions

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Cover this until after your first attempt

The reserved room type is unavailable, and I'm sorry for the inconvenience. Let me explain the two available options, including any differences in facilities or cost, so you can choose what works for you.

Second round

The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Revenue Management and Pricing

SHARED CASE

A hotel reports a higher average daily rate but lower occupancy. A manager assumes every revenue measure must have improved.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

The average rate and occupancy moved in different directions. We need to look at revenue per available room as well before describing the overall room-revenue performance.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

SHARED CASE

Housekeeping marks a room cleaned, but maintenance has an open repair request. Reception asks whether it can be assigned.

Role A | Responding professional

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Useful expressions

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Cover this until after your first attempt

Cleaning is complete, but the maintenance request is still open. Please confirm the room's approved status with the responsible team before telling reception that it is available.

Second round

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

SHARED CASE

An event schedule lists "sound check" without a time, room, or responsible contact. The venue and organizer assume the other will arrange it.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could we confirm the sound-check time, location, and contact person? I'll add those details to the run of show so the venue and organizer share the same plan.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

SHARED CASE

Heavy weather may affect an excursion. The operator has not confirmed whether it will proceed. Guests ask if the original itinerary is certain.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The operator is reviewing the conditions, so the itinerary is not yet confirmed. I'll share the next official update and explain any approved alternatives when they are available.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Cultural Expectations and Service Style

SHARED CASE

A guest declines an offered service. A colleague assumes the reason is the guest's nationality.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Let's ask about the guest's preference rather than assume the reason. Would you prefer a different arrangement, or would you like us to explain the available options?

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Arrival confirmed, room not ready

Fictional hotel training: a corporate travel coordinator arrives with a guest group before rooms are ready; luggage storage is available, but readiness is unverified.

01 • Travel coordinator: Your confirmation said everything was ready. Our delegates expected to check in immediately.

02 • Front desk supervisor: I'm sorry our message confused confirmed reservations with rooms ready for occupancy.

03 • Travel coordinator: We have a meeting shortly. Can you give us an exact waiting time?

04 • Front desk supervisor: Not yet. Housekeeping hasn't confirmed readiness, and I shouldn't invent a time.

05 • Travel coordinator: Could you at least take the cases while we attend the meeting?

06 • Front desk supervisor: Yes, luggage storage is available. I'll also request an update on room inventory.

07 • Travel coordinator: Does that mean an upgrade is possible if our rooms remain unavailable?

08 • Front desk supervisor: I can ask, but no upgrade has been approved or confirmed available.

09 • Travel coordinator: Please store the luggage and contact me when you have verified information.

10 • Front desk supervisor: Certainly. I'll keep the room status separate from any service recovery request.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The breakfast inclusion correction

Separate fictional case: a reservation lists room only, but an agent's welcome message incorrectly says breakfast included; a corporate booking manager calls.

01 • Booking manager: Your welcome message includes breakfast, but our travelers were asked to pay today.

02 • Reservations agent: I've checked the reservation. It says room only; my welcome message was incorrect.

03 • Booking manager: That mistake affects the meal budget I gave everyone before their arrival.

04 • Reservations agent: I'm sorry. I should have checked the booked package before sending that wording.

05 • Booking manager: Can you simply add breakfast to all six rooms for the remaining nights?

06 • Reservations agent: That requires approval. I can take the discrepancy to our front desk supervisor.

07 • Booking manager: Please don't describe this as guests misunderstanding the package they were offered.

08 • Reservations agent: Agreed. I'll explain that our message created an expectation the reservation doesn't match.

09 • Booking manager: Please give me the corrected booking details and tell me who is reviewing compensation.

10 • Reservations agent: I'll confirm the room-only status and identify the supervisor handling the service recovery request.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A quiet-room request is not a guarantee

Separate fictional case: a tour leader's arrival sheet incorrectly calls a quiet-room request guaranteed; no alternative room has been verified.

01 • Tour leader: My arrival sheet guarantees courtyard rooms, but your colleague says they're only requested.

02 • Duty manager: You're right to question that. Our sheet overstated the status of the request.

03 • Tour leader: Several travelers chose this hotel because they wanted rooms away from street noise.

04 • Duty manager: I'm sorry we created that expectation. The courtyard preference is recorded, not guaranteed.

05 • Tour leader: What can you actually do before I distribute the room keys today?

06 • Duty manager: I'll check current room inventory and ask reception to explain verified options individually.

07 • Tour leader: Can I announce that everyone will receive an upgrade instead of a courtyard room?

08 • Duty manager: No upgrade is confirmed. Please tell them we're checking assignments, without promising an alternative.

09 • Tour leader: I'll correct the announcement, but I need one contact for any further concerns.

10 • Duty manager: I'll be that contact and review the service recovery options after checking availability.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

A guest arrives before the room is ready after receiving an unclear confirmation message. The desk has a luggage-storage option but no verified room-ready time.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: I'm sorry the message was unclear. Your room is not ready yet. We can store your luggage while I check the status, and I'll give you an update as soon as I have a confirmed time.

Scenario 2 | An arrival entrance changes

In a fictional hotel, a conference group's confirmation names the main entrance, but its booked reception desk is at the garden entrance. Both entrances are open; luggage assistance has not been confirmed. Correct the message by phone before arrival.

Role A: Front desk supervisor: acknowledge the incorrect entrance instruction and explain the verified reception location.

Role B: Conference coordinator: explain that delegates have the old instruction and ask about luggage assistance.

Possible opening: Our confirmation named the wrong reception entrance, and I want to correct that before your group arrives.

Success checks

- Take responsibility for the incorrect message.
- Distinguish the confirmed entrance from unconfirmed assistance.
- Agree how the coordinator will pass on the correction.

Add a complication: The coordinator asks you to guarantee that a porter will meet the coach, but availability is unknown.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Remove the booking details from the reply

Fictional review meeting: a draft public response quotes a guest's booking reference and disputes the complaint; nothing has been posted.

01 • Guest relations manager: Your draft includes the booking reference and says the guest's account is completely wrong.

02 • Social media coordinator: I wanted readers to see that we had actually checked the guest complaint.

03 • Guest relations manager: The reference exposes booking details, and the accusation makes our brand voice sound defensive.

04 • Social media coordinator: I see the privacy concern. How can we show we're taking the complaint seriously?

05 • Guest relations manager: Acknowledge the reported experience, then invite a private conversation through our established contact channel.

06 • Social media coordinator: Should we mention compensation publicly so other readers know we're offering a solution?

07 • Guest relations manager: Nothing is approved. A public promise would create another expectation we might not meet.

08 • Social media coordinator: I'll remove the reference and replace the argument with an invitation to follow up privately.

09 • Guest relations manager: Good. What made the original response difficult to write in a neutral way?

10 • Social media coordinator: I confused correcting facts with arguing. Please review the revision with me before publication.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The apology that ignored the noise

Separate fictional case: a hotel response thanks a reviewer for praising breakfast but ignores their detailed noise complaint.

01 • Quality manager: The reply mentions breakfast twice, but it never acknowledges the reported overnight noise.

02 • Guest relations agent: I focused on the positive comment because we haven't verified the noise source.

03 • Quality manager: That makes the guest complaint look ignored. Acknowledging their report doesn't confirm its cause.

04 • Guest relations agent: So I can say we're sorry their sleep was disturbed without blaming maintenance?

05 • Quality manager: Yes. Keep the cause open and explain how they can discuss the experience privately.

06 • Guest relations agent: Would promising that the noise will never happen again make the apology stronger?

07 • Quality manager: It would make an unsupported promise. Our brand voice should be courteous and credible.

08 • Guest relations agent: I'll acknowledge the disturbance and offer a private follow-up without guaranteeing a technical fix.

09 • Quality manager: That addresses the omission. Could we check the next three replies for the same pattern?

10 • Guest relations agent: Certainly. I'll make sure each reply responds to the specific concern, not just compliments.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Feedback on an interrupted complaint call

Separate fictional coaching case: a supervisor and reservations agent review a training call in which the agent interrupts a conference organizer twice.

01 • Reservations supervisor: During the practice call, you interrupted twice while the organizer was describing the billing concern.

02 • Reservations agent: I thought I already understood it and wanted to resolve the guest complaint quickly.

03 • Reservations supervisor: The organizer then repeated the story. That lengthened the call and increased frustration.

04 • Reservations agent: I noticed that too. Should I stay silent until every detail has been explained?

05 • Reservations supervisor: Let the main concern finish, then summarize it and ask one focused question.

06 • Reservations agent: What if the organizer requests compensation before I have checked the billing record?

07 • Reservations supervisor: Acknowledge the request without approving it. Explain which details you need to review first.

08 • Reservations agent: I'll practice saying, 'You're questioning the room charge; have I understood the concern correctly?'

09 • Reservations supervisor: Good. Let's replay the opening and see whether that gives the organizer room to respond.

10 • Reservations agent: Afterward, please tell me whether my summary captures the concern without assuming an outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

A draft response to an online review argues with the guest and includes booking details. The team needs a courteous public reply.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can explain a practical obstacle affecting the work. Share it after your partner asks for your perspective, then agree on one observable change.

Second round: The recipient disagrees with your interpretation. Return to the observed example, listen, and revise an unsupported assumption.

Model for scenario 1: Thank you for sharing your experience. We're sorry the visit did not meet expectations. Please contact our service team through the private channel so we can review the details with you.

Scenario 2 | A reply sounds copied

A fictional hotel's response to a complaint about a missed wake-up call thanks the guest for their restaurant feedback. The response is still a draft. Hold a coaching conversation and agree one check before posting.

Role A: Guest relations supervisor: identify the exact mismatch and its likely effect without criticizing personality.

Role B: Trainee: explain that you reused a draft and ask how to check relevance efficiently.

Possible opening: This draft refers to restaurant feedback, but the guest complained about a missed wake-up call.

Success checks

- Describe the observed mismatch rather than labeling the trainee.
- Invite the trainee's perspective.
- Agree a specific check that preserves a courteous brand voice.

Add a complication: The trainee says using a template is necessary during busy periods.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Twin rooms or a partner property

Fictional overbooking case: a hotel authorizes either two twin rooms onsite or two doubles at a partner property for one night at the booked total; transport is not yet arranged.

01 • Reservations manager: Our overbooking means the two doubles are unavailable tonight. We have two approved alternatives.

02 • Tour coordinator: The travelers need separate rooms, but they strongly prefer the double beds they booked.

03 • Reservations manager: They can take two twins here or two doubles at our partner property tonight.

04 • Tour coordinator: Would a walk to the partner property change the total accommodation charge for them?

05 • Reservations manager: For this arrangement, the booked total stays the same. Transport still needs arranging.

06 • Tour coordinator: Then I can't accept it until I know how they'll reach the other hotel.

07 • Reservations manager: Understood. If the transfer arrangements suit them, we can proceed with that alternative.

08 • Tour coordinator: Please check transport first. I won't announce a confirmed move while that remains open.

09 • Reservations manager: I'll coordinate the transfer request and keep the onsite twin option clear in our discussion.

10 • Tour coordinator: Once you have those details, I'll ask the travelers which tradeoff they prefer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Keeping a three-night stay together

Separate fictional case: a group can book six standard rooms for three nights or six superior rooms for two nights followed by a move to standard rooms; quoted totals are equal.

01 • Group sales agent: We can keep six standard rooms for all three nights, or offer superior rooms initially.

02 • Event planner: Initially sounds uncertain. How many nights would those superior rooms actually cover for this group?

03 • Group sales agent: Two nights, followed by a move to standard rooms. Both quoted totals are equal.

04 • Event planner: Our final morning is busy. Can you guarantee the move won't interrupt the program?

05 • Group sales agent: I can't guarantee that. Staying in standard rooms avoids that planned room change entirely.

06 • Event planner: The upgrade is attractive, but moving luggage matters more than the larger room size.

07 • Group sales agent: Then the standard allocation may fit better, provided your delegates accept that room category.

08 • Event planner: I'll take that choice to them. Please don't release the booking as superior rooms.

09 • Group sales agent: I'll record the proposed standard allocation and request your decision before confirming the rooming list.

10 • Event planner: Good. I'll explain the room-category and room-change tradeoff instead of describing the options as identical.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Comparing channel offers fairly

Separate fictional reservation case: a direct offer includes breakfast and flexible cancellation; an agency offer is room only with different cancellation terms. No matched rate has been authorized.

01 • Corporate travel buyer: The agency rate is lower. Can you match it and keep your direct-booking benefits?

02 • Revenue coordinator: The offers differ: ours includes breakfast and flexible cancellation; the agency's is room only.

03 • Corporate travel buyer: I thought rate parity meant the same room always had exactly the same price.

04 • Revenue coordinator: We need to compare the actual offers and terms, not assume those packages are equivalent.

05 • Corporate travel buyer: Our travelers need breakfast, but their dates are fixed. Could you quote that combination?

06 • Revenue coordinator: I can request a separate quote. I can't confirm a matched rate without approval.

07 • Corporate travel buyer: Then give me the existing choices while the tailored quote is under review.

08 • Revenue coordinator: You can consider the flexible breakfast package or the agency's room-only offer under its conditions.

09 • Corporate travel buyer: I'll compare the full stay cost and cancellation terms before asking anyone to book.

10 • Revenue coordinator: I'll identify the pending quote clearly so it isn't mistaken for an approved reservation offer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

A booking issue means the reserved room type is unavailable. Staff have two alternatives within their approved service process.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Second round: The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Model for scenario 1: The reserved room type is unavailable, and I'm sorry for the inconvenience. Let me explain the two available options, including any differences in facilities or cost, so you can choose what works for you.

Scenario 2 | One room category for a later arrival

A fictional retreat can reserve four identical rooms starting Wednesday, or two standard and two superior rooms starting Tuesday. The retreat organizer prefers Tuesday and identical rooms. No further inventory is confirmed. Negotiate a proposal for organizer approval.

Role A: Reservations coordinator: offer the two verified allocations and make the date or room-category tradeoff explicit.

Role B: Retreat planner: decide which compromise to propose to your director, without claiming their approval.

Possible opening: We can keep the room category consistent from Wednesday, or accommodate Tuesday arrival with two categories.

Success checks

- Compare both allocations accurately.
- State what requires the director's approval.
- Avoid promising future room availability.

Add a complication: The planner asks you to promise that Tuesday inventory will improve tomorrow.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Higher room price, lower room revenue

Fictional daily comparison: 100 available rooms on each day; day one sells 80 at an average of 100 units, day two sells 60 at 120 units. Figures exclude other revenue.

01 • Hotel manager: Average daily rate increased from 100 to 120. Surely room revenue improved as well.

02 • Revenue analyst: Not in this example. We sold 80 rooms before, but only 60 on the second day.

03 • Hotel manager: I understand occupancy fell, but how does that affect the measure on this slide?

04 • Revenue analyst: RevPAR is room revenue per available room. It includes the effect of unsold rooms.

05 • Hotel manager: So ADR describes the rooms sold, while RevPAR also reflects the available room inventory?

06 • Revenue analyst: Exactly. Room revenue was 8,000, then 7,200, across the same 100 available rooms.

07 • Hotel manager: That gives RevPAR of 80 and 72, despite the higher average selling price.

08 • Revenue analyst: Correct. Neither measure alone tells us profit, because we haven't included the relevant costs.

09 • Hotel manager: I'll explain the price increase and occupancy decline together in the management briefing.

10 • Revenue analyst: Good. Keep the comparison limited to these two days and these room-revenue figures.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A compression night is not every night

Separate fictional case: the hotel has high demand on Saturday during a convention, but Friday and Sunday bookings remain lower.

- 01 • Conference sales manager:** You called Saturday a compression night. Does that mean the entire weekend is sold out?
- 02 • Revenue manager:** No. Here it describes concentrated demand on Saturday; Friday and Sunday bookings are still lower.
- 03 • Conference sales manager:** Then why does the proposed group quote show different prices across the three nights?
- 04 • Revenue manager:** The proposal reflects those different demand conditions. Yield management considers when and how inventory is sold.
- 05 • Conference sales manager:** Could I explain it as charging every convention guest more because they must attend?
- 06 • Revenue manager:** That would misrepresent the proposal. Explain the specific nightly prices and conditions without guessing guests' motives.
- 07 • Conference sales manager:** Would higher Saturday demand establish that the whole three-night package produces better revenue?
- 08 • Revenue manager:** We'd still need the full booking mix and room revenue across all three nights.
- 09 • Conference sales manager:** I'll describe Saturday separately and avoid saying the entire weekend has identical demand.
- 10 • Revenue manager:** That distinction will help the planner compare the package without confusing a peak with the average.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Room revenue is not total event revenue

Separate fictional case: a conference booking includes 4,000 units of room revenue and 2,000 of banquet revenue; a trainee puts 6,000 into the hotel's room-revenue measure.

01 • Revenue controller: Your calculation includes banquet revenue in the room-revenue total. Can we separate those amounts?

02 • Management trainee: The conference brought in 6,000 overall, so I thought all of it belonged in RevPAR.

03 • Revenue controller: For this report, RevPAR uses room revenue. The banquet amount belongs in its own category.

04 • Management trainee: Then 4,000 is the room component, and 2,000 belongs to food and event service?

05 • Revenue controller: Correct. Combining them would make this booking look stronger against a room-only comparison unfairly.

06 • Management trainee: Does separating the figures mean the banquet business is less valuable to the hotel?

07 • Revenue controller: No. It means we're keeping the measures consistent before discussing the total business contribution.

08 • Management trainee: I'll show room revenue and banquet revenue separately, then give the combined total below.

09 • Revenue controller: Good. What additional information would you need before calling that total a profit figure?

10 • Management trainee: The associated costs. Revenue tells us what came in, not what remains after expenses.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Revenue Management and Pricing

A hotel reports a higher average daily rate but lower occupancy. A manager assumes every revenue measure must have improved.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: The average rate and occupancy moved in different directions. We need to look at revenue per available room as well before describing the overall room-revenue performance.

Scenario 2 | An average hides two room types

A fictional report shows a higher ADR this week, but more suites were sold and standard-room prices were unchanged. No profit data are supplied. Explain the possible booking-mix effect to a sales colleague.

Role A: Revenue analyst: distinguish a higher average selling rate from an increase in every room's price.

Role B: Sales coordinator: paraphrase the distinction and ask what comparison would clarify it.

Possible opening: The average rate rose, but that does not mean the standard-room price increased.

Success checks

- Explain ADR in familiar words.
- Identify the change in room mix.
- Avoid inferring profit without cost information.

Add a complication: The coordinator wants to tell the team that every room became more profitable.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Cleaned is not released

Fictional shift handoff: room 214 is cleaned, but its maintenance repair request remains open and its assignment status has not been cleared.

01 • Housekeeping supervisor: Room 214 has been cleaned, but the maintenance request remains open on our handover list.

02 • Front desk lead: The cleaning update reached reception. Does that mean I can assign the room now?

03 • Housekeeping supervisor: No release is recorded. Cleaned describes our work, not confirmation that the repair is complete.

04 • Front desk lead: Who has accepted the follow-up? I don't want another shift assuming someone checked it.

05 • Housekeeping supervisor: I still own the follow-up and will contact maintenance for the outstanding repair status.

06 • Front desk lead: Please keep the room status clear while you do that; our arrival queue is growing.

07 • Housekeeping supervisor: Understood. I'll report the verified status to you rather than estimating when it becomes available.

08 • Front desk lead: So 214 is cleaned, repair unresolved, and you are checking with maintenance. Correct?

09 • Housekeeping supervisor: Correct. Any release must come through the hotel's authorized room-status process after that check.

10 • Front desk lead: I've accepted the reception handoff and will ensure the cleaning note isn't treated as release.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An out-of-order room carries into tomorrow

Separate fictional case: room 509 is out of order pending a replacement part; the supplier has not confirmed delivery. An incoming maintenance coordinator takes over supplier follow-up.

01 • Outgoing maintenance coordinator: Room 509 remains out of order. The replacement part is requested, but delivery isn't confirmed.

02 • Incoming maintenance coordinator: Has anyone told reception that tomorrow's turnover can include it in available inventory?

03 • Outgoing maintenance coordinator: No. Our last update said the delivery timing was unknown and the repair remained open.

04 • Incoming maintenance coordinator: I'll take supplier follow-up. Where is the part reference and the most recent contact recorded?

05 • Outgoing maintenance coordinator: Both are in the maintenance request for 509, with the last call marked unanswered.

06 • Incoming maintenance coordinator: An unanswered call isn't supplier acceptance. I'll keep that distinction in the next update.

07 • Outgoing maintenance coordinator: Thank you. Please also tell reception who now owns the follow-up on this room.

08 • Incoming maintenance coordinator: I'll confirm ownership to reception and report the supplier's response without promising a release date.

09 • Outgoing maintenance coordinator: Can you repeat the current status so I know the key information transferred correctly?

10 • Incoming maintenance coordinator: 509 stays out of order; delivery and repair are pending, and I own supplier follow-up.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A preventive visit clashes with a group arrival

Separate fictional case: preventive maintenance is booked for room 318 tomorrow morning, and a new group allocation lists the same room; no revised appointment is approved.

01 • Rooms coordinator: Tomorrow's group allocation includes 318, but preventive maintenance is still scheduled there that morning.

02 • Maintenance planner: Thanks for flagging it. Has the room allocation already been communicated as final to the group?

03 • Rooms coordinator: It's an internal draft. I haven't confirmed that room number to the tour coordinator.

04 • Maintenance planner: Then please keep the conflict visible. A proposed allocation doesn't cancel the maintenance appointment.

05 • Rooms coordinator: Can you take responsibility for checking whether the appointment can move without affecting the plan?

06 • Maintenance planner: Yes, I'll ask the authorized scheduler. I cannot approve that change myself during this handoff.

07 • Rooms coordinator: I'll retain ownership of the group allocation and wait for your scheduling update.

08 • Maintenance planner: To confirm, you manage room assignment, and I check the unresolved preventive maintenance conflict.

09 • Rooms coordinator: Exactly. Neither of us should mark the room available on the strength of this conversation.

10 • Maintenance planner: Agreed. I'll return a confirmed scheduling status, or clearly state that approval is still pending.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Housekeeping marks a room cleaned, but maintenance has an open repair request. Reception asks whether it can be assigned.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: Cleaning is complete, but the maintenance request is still open. Please confirm the room's approved status with the responsible team before telling reception that it is available.

Scenario 2 | The linen delivery handoff

A fictional hotel has received twelve of twenty requested linen bundles. Eight are outstanding, and the delivery time is unknown. The evening supervisor must take over supplier contact and keep reception informed about turnover capacity.

Role A: Day housekeeping supervisor: hand over received and missing quantities and request explicit acceptance.

Role B: Evening housekeeping supervisor: accept supplier follow-up and ask what cannot yet be promised to reception.

Possible opening: Twelve linen bundles are here; eight remain outstanding, and their arrival time is unconfirmed.

Success checks

- Repeat back the received and outstanding quantities.
- Name the person taking supplier follow-up.
- Do not convert missing delivery information into a room-ready promise.

Add a complication: Reception asks whether all remaining rooms will be ready in one hour.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

What does sound check include?

Fictional banquet planning call: the run of show lists sound check without a room, time, or owner; the organizer knows the presenter needs a wireless microphone.

01 • Banquet coordinator: The run of show lists sound check, but it doesn't identify a room or responsible contact.

02 • Event organizer: I assumed your venue arranged that automatically. Our presenter needs a wireless microphone for the talk.

03 • Banquet coordinator: Could you clarify whether sound check means testing that microphone or rehearsing the whole presentation?

04 • Event organizer: Only the microphone test is required. I haven't arranged a full rehearsal with the presenter.

05 • Banquet coordinator: Which event room should we use? I shouldn't infer that from the incomplete schedule entry.

06 • Event organizer: That still needs confirmation. Can we identify the missing decisions before choosing a test time?

07 • Banquet coordinator: Yes. We need the room, presenter availability, and the AV contact who accepts the task.

08 • Event organizer: I'll confirm the room and presenter availability; can you identify the appropriate venue contact?

09 • Banquet coordinator: I can request that assignment. I'll keep the AV requirement pending in the banquet event order.

10 • Event organizer: Then no sound check is confirmed yet. We'll agree the time once those details are available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Doors open for whom?

Separate fictional event case: a schedule says doors open at 17:00; suppliers need access, and attendees arrive at 18:00. The meaning of the 17:00 entry is unclear.

01 • Venue operations manager: Your schedule says doors open at five. Does that refer to suppliers or invited attendees?

02 • Conference producer: Attendees arrive at six, but I can't tell whether the five o'clock entry means supplier access.

03 • Venue operations manager: That distinction affects staffing. Could you confirm who created the entry before we brief the team?

04 • Conference producer: I'll ask the production assistant. In the meantime, let's label attendee arrival separately at six.

05 • Venue operations manager: Agreed. Do suppliers need loading access only, or access to the event room as well?

06 • Conference producer: That hasn't been specified. I should collect their access requirements instead of assuming both.

07 • Venue operations manager: Please include the access point and receiving contact when you confirm the run of show.

08 • Conference producer: Would you like me to call once those points are verified, before circulating the revised schedule?

09 • Venue operations manager: Yes. We can then check that the banquet event order and staffing brief use the same wording.

10 • Conference producer: I'll confirm the five o'clock meaning and supplier requirements; six remains the verified attendee arrival time.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A guarantee is not an attendance forecast

Separate fictional planning case: a draft BEO lists 90 expected attendees and a separate guaranteed count of 80; the organizer asks what number catering should prepare against.

01 • Catering manager: The banquet event order shows 90 expected attendees and a guaranteed count of 80.

02 • Association planner: I thought those were two labels for the same number. Which entry are you asking about?

03 • Catering manager: I'm asking which count has been agreed for service planning under this event's arrangements.

04 • Association planner: The forecast is 90, but I haven't checked the agreement behind the guaranteed count.

05 • Catering manager: Then we should verify that before changing quantities or making any statement about attrition charges.

06 • Association planner: Could you clarify what document and section your team needs me to check first?

07 • Catering manager: Please check the event agreement's attendance and catering provisions, then confirm the current approved count.

08 • Association planner: I'll ask our authorized organizer to review them. Can the forecast remain clearly labeled meanwhile?

09 • Catering manager: Yes. Expected attendance and an agreed guarantee should stay separate in the BEO until clarified.

10 • Association planner: Understood. I'll return with the approved count rather than treating my attendance estimate as authorization.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

An event schedule lists "sound check" without a time, room, or responsible contact. The venue and organizer assume the other will arrange it.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Could we confirm the sound-check time, location, and contact person? I'll add those details to the run of show so the venue and organizer share the same plan.

Scenario 2 | Which screen needs the live feed?

A fictional event's AV requirement says live feed. A lobby screen and a stage screen are available, but the requested destination and content are unspecified. The producer and AV coordinator must clarify these before requesting a test.

Role A: AV coordinator: ask focused questions about the screen and intended content.

Role B: Event producer: confirm the lobby screen is intended, but acknowledge that the camera view has not been selected.

Possible opening: When the run of show says live feed, which screen should receive it?

Success checks

- Identify the lobby as the confirmed destination.
- Keep the camera view and testing status open.
- Agree who will obtain the remaining content decision.

Add a complication: The producer asks you to mark the AV requirement complete before the camera view is agreed.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Weather concern without a departure decision

Fictional excursion coordination: heavy weather may affect a trip; the local operator has not confirmed whether it will proceed.

01 • Hotel concierge: Guests are asking whether tomorrow's excursion will follow the original itinerary despite the weather.

02 • Tour operations coordinator: Heavy weather may affect it, but the local operator hasn't confirmed a departure decision yet.

03 • Hotel concierge: The booking remains visible online. Can I treat that as confirmation the trip is proceeding?

04 • Tour operations coordinator: No. A visible booking isn't an operational update, and we shouldn't make that inference.

05 • Hotel concierge: What can I tell the group without making the situation sound more certain than it is?

06 • Tour operations coordinator: Say the itinerary is under review and we're awaiting the operator's confirmed status.

07 • Hotel concierge: Should I also say their waiver means the excursion is safe to run in this weather?

08 • Tour operations coordinator: No. A waiver doesn't establish current conditions or replace the operator's authorized safety decision.

09 • Hotel concierge: I'll keep the departure status unconfirmed and direct operational questions through your contact.

10 • Tour operations coordinator: I'll request the verified update and separate any itinerary change from unanswered refund questions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A photograph is not a trail assessment

Separate fictional tour case: a guide receives an old photograph of a wet trail; no current route assessment has been provided by the local operator.

01 • Tour guide: A traveler shared a wet-trail photograph and says it proves tomorrow's route is closed.

02 • Excursion manager: Do we know when the photograph was taken or whether it shows our planned route?

03 • Tour guide: It's from last month, and the location hasn't been verified against the itinerary.

04 • Excursion manager: Then it doesn't establish today's route status. We need the local operator's current assessment.

05 • Tour guide: Can I dismiss the concern because the photograph is old and might show somewhere else?

06 • Excursion manager: Don't dismiss it. Acknowledge the concern while explaining why this evidence doesn't settle the question.

07 • Tour guide: I'll say we haven't confirmed a closure or established that the route is suitable.

08 • Excursion manager: That's accurate. Ask the operator for the current route status through our coordination channel.

09 • Tour guide: Until that arrives, I'll avoid proposing an alternative trail based on my own assumptions.

10 • Excursion manager: Good. Any revised itinerary needs the appropriate review, not just a reassuring answer to the group.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Cancellation does not settle the contract question

Separate fictional case: a local operator has confirmed cancellation of a harbor tour due to weather; the hotel's coordinator has not reviewed the booking's refund terms.

01 • Travel coordinator: The harbor tour is canceled because of weather. Does force majeure mean nobody receives a refund?

02 • Excursion supervisor: We have a confirmed cancellation, but we haven't reviewed the relevant terms for these bookings.

03 • Travel coordinator: The operator used that phrase in its message. I assumed it settled the payment question.

04 • Excursion supervisor: It doesn't let us infer each traveler's contractual position from this message alone.

05 • Travel coordinator: So the cancellation is known, while the refund outcome still needs an authorized review?

06 • Excursion supervisor: Exactly. We can explain the confirmed itinerary change and refer the payment question for review.

07 • Travel coordinator: Guests will want a definite answer. Can we at least promise a replacement tour?

08 • Excursion supervisor: No replacement is confirmed. We can ask about options without presenting them as approved compensation.

09 • Travel coordinator: I'll separate the operational announcement from the unresolved refund and alternative-tour questions.

10 • Excursion supervisor: Please do. I'll gather the booking terms and operator notice for the appropriate reviewer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Heavy weather may affect an excursion. The operator has not confirmed whether it will proceed. Guests ask if the original itinerary is certain.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The operator is reviewing the conditions, so the itinerary is not yet confirmed. I'll share the next official update and explain any approved alternatives when they are available.

Scenario 2 | A museum stop may be unavailable

A fictional tour includes a museum. Its public page mentions building work but gives no closure dates, and the local operator has not verified access for the booked day. Discuss what can be said to the group.

Role A: Tour planner: explain the evidence and ask the operator to verify the booked visit.

Role B: Hotel concierge: challenge a proposed announcement that the museum stop is canceled.

Possible opening: The museum mentions building work, but we haven't established whether it affects our booked visit.

Success checks

- Distinguish the published notice from a verified closure.
- Avoid guaranteeing or canceling the visit without confirmation.
- Agree who will seek the operator's update.

Add a complication: A traveler asks whether the unchanged itinerary on their voucher proves access is guaranteed.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Ask before interpreting a declined service

Fictional staff coaching: a guest declines luggage assistance; a porter attributes the choice to nationality, although the guest gave no reason.

01 • Porter: The guest declined luggage assistance. People from that country probably prefer carrying everything themselves.

02 • Guest services supervisor: We don't know that. What did the guest actually say when you offered the service?

03 • Porter: Only 'No, thank you.' They didn't explain why they preferred not to use it.

04 • Guest services supervisor: Then respect the choice without adding a cultural explanation to the guest profile.

05 • Porter: Should I ask them why they refused, so we can improve our service standard?

06 • Guest services supervisor: There's no need to press for a reason. Ask about future assistance only if it's useful.

07 • Porter: I could say, 'Would you like us to leave you to settle in, or help later?'

08 • Guest services supervisor: Yes, provided it doesn't become repeated pressure after they've clearly declined assistance.

09 • Porter: I'll record only a relevant stated preference, not a guess about nationality or personality.

10 • Guest services supervisor: Good. Our service can respond to the individual without treating an assumption as a cultural expectation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A recovery gesture needs a preference check

Separate fictional case: a hotel may offer flowers or a fruit basket as an approved recovery gesture; neither has been selected for a corporate traveler.

01 • Guest relations coordinator: We can offer flowers or a fruit basket after the room mix-up. Which should we send?

02 • Duty manager: Have we asked the traveler whether they would welcome either recovery gesture in their room?

03 • Guest relations coordinator: No. I assumed flowers would be more appropriate based on the guest's profile photograph.

04 • Duty manager: A photograph doesn't tell us that preference. We should offer the options without making that assumption.

05 • Guest relations coordinator: Could asking spoil the gesture and make the apology feel less personal to them?

06 • Duty manager: It can be considerate. Explain the options briefly and make clear that declining is perfectly acceptable.

07 • Guest relations coordinator: I'll ask, 'Would either option be welcome, or would you prefer no delivery?'

08 • Duty manager: That works. Don't infer dietary preferences from the guest's name when discussing the fruit basket.

09 • Guest relations coordinator: I'll confirm the choice directly and record only what is needed for this delivery.

10 • Duty manager: Then the gesture supports the apology rather than imposing our idea of good service.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Formal or first-name introductions

Separate fictional case: an event host asks a hotel team how to address an international delegation; delegates have not provided individual preferences.

01 • Event host: Should the reception team use first names for everyone? The delegation is attending an informal retreat.

02 • Front office trainer: Informal describes the event, but it doesn't confirm every delegate's preferred form of address.

03 • Event host: We have names on the rooming list. Could we choose a style based on their countries?

04 • Front office trainer: That would substitute a national assumption for an individual preference we can ask about respectfully.

05 • Event host: How can the team ask without turning each check-in into an awkward interview?

06 • Front office trainer: A simple 'How would you prefer us to address you?' allows a direct answer.

07 • Event host: And if someone doesn't express a preference, should we invent one for the guest profile?

08 • Front office trainer: No. Follow our service standard while keeping any unconfirmed preference out of the record.

09 • Event host: I'll brief the team to ask naturally and use the answer consistently during the stay.

10 • Front office trainer: Good. Clarifying a preference is more reliable than trying to predict it from a nationality.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Cultural Expectations and Service Style

A guest declines an offered service. A colleague assumes the reason is the guest's nationality.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Let's ask about the guest's preference rather than assume the reason. Would you prefer a different arrangement, or would you like us to explain the available options?

Scenario 2 | How should reception contact the organizer?

A fictional organizer is in meetings between 10:00 and 12:00. Reception can use a phone call or a written message for routine room updates. Their preferred channel is unknown. Agree a communication preference by speaking before the meetings.

Role A: Reception supervisor: ask which available channel the organizer prefers for routine updates.

Role B: Event organizer: choose written messages during the meetings and phone calls afterward.

Possible opening: Which contact method would work best for routine room updates while you're in meetings?

Success checks

- Ask the individual rather than infer a group preference.
- Repeat the two time-dependent channel choices accurately.
- Limit the agreement to routine updates rather than inventing emergency procedures.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests inferring the preference from the organizer's age instead of asking.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Hospitality and Tourism English

Professional audience: hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Dialogue 01: Arrival before check-in

Original fictional setting: Front desk and housekeeping coordinate an early arrival.

Professional roles: Front-desk agent / Housekeeping supervisor

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Front-desk agent: Our group arrived an hour early. Do we have any inspected rooms ready?

Housekeeping supervisor: Six are clean, but only four have passed inspection. I'll confirm those room numbers.

Front-desk agent: I'll offer luggage storage and explain that the remaining rooms are still being prepared.

Housekeeping supervisor: Please don't issue keys for the two uninspected rooms yet.

Front-desk agent: Understood. Can you give me a time for the next room-status update?

Housekeeping supervisor: I'll update the property-management system after inspection and call you if any room is delayed.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

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Front-desk agent: Understood. Can you give me a time for the next room-status update?

Housekeeping supervisor: I'll update the property-management system after inspection and call you if any room is delayed.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level